

The Unknown Tower and Halls

By Steven K Allen

Scorge30@hotmail.com

eastern corner of the room near the stairs. Set in the center of the southern wall is a pair of rusty iron-reinforced wooden doors, shut tightly. The wooden floor bears the jumbled and smeared tracks of several humans wearing boots. A few of these tracks enter the stable.

The stone-top table was once a fine piece of marble six feet long with oak legs and brass bracing. The ruined table has nothing of worth, except a few pieces of moldy parchment, water damaged but usable. The double doors are not locked and will open on rusty protesting hinges revealing the stables.

The 10' diameter hole in the center of the tower descends 30' to end in room #T5, the foyer to the gauth's lair. A character dropping through this hole is likely to encounter the gauth, although the gauth would rather wait until the intruders are within the stables where it has prepared its trap, it will attack anything that enters its lair.

While the characters are searching the first floor, unless they are being careful and quiet, there is a 90% chance that the gauth will be alerted to their presence and will silently observe the characters waiting to attack, trying to discern which ones might be spell casters. It will cast *Invisibility* upon itself and watch silently as the characters search the tower. Those characters displaying the use of spells are noted and will be attacked first, preferably in the stables. When the characters head for the stables, it will float through the underground chasm, rising under the false hay pile using several eyes to watch the progress of the characters. If discovered, the gauth immediately attacks.

T2, The Stable.

This dry stable is dark, 25' wide by 50' long and appears empty. The crude thatched roof seems to be holding the majority of the weather out. Within the stable are 10 wooden stalls along the western wall and a 10' high pile of dry straw on the eastern wall. To the south hang a pair of rusty iron-reinforced wooden doors that are barred by an equally rusty iron-reinforced wooden crosspiece set into rusty iron rings on the doors and walls.

Searching the stalls reveals that four of the stalls each contain a different stone statue. Stall number one has a large owlbear statue standing on its hind legs with its head raised as if to look at something. Stall number two has a large white tail buck frozen while jumping. Stall number three has a male human warrior dressed in scale mail with a bastard sword raised over his head in a two-handed strike and a frozen look of utter terror on his face. Stall number four has a human female dressed in course robes half reclining on a pile of blankets on the floor with her hands covering her eyes while her mouth is open in a silent scream.

The gauth will wait until the characters are all looking at the statues, which puts their backs to him. He will then rise slowly from the hay, cause himself to glow brightly and commences to blast the characters with his eyes, trying to keep as many characters within the effective range of his central eye as possible.

Gauth 9+9 HD: Int. 15-16 Exceptionally intelligent; AL NE; AC 0; MV 0, Fl 9(B); HD 9+9; hp 51; THAC0 11; #AT 1; Dmg 3-12; SA Magic; SD Regeneration; SZ L; ML Champion-Fanatic (15-18); XP 9,000¹⁰.

The Gauth is a relative of the beholder that feeds on magic. Located in the center of the gauth's forward hemisphere is a large central eye surrounded by a ring of smaller eyes that are protected by ridges of tough flesh. These secondary body eyes provide the creature with normal vision in lighted areas and infravision to 90 feet. On the underside is the beast's fearsome mouth with its accompanying cluster of four feeding tendrils, while the top is adorned with a crown of six eyestalks. Attacks on the creature hit as follows:

Roll	Location	AC	Hit Points
01-85	Body	0	As listed
86-90	Central Eye	7	Part of Body
91-00	Eyestalk/Tendrils	2	6 hit points

When a gauth moves into combat, it begins to glow, much as if it were the object of a faerie fire spell, to attract the attention of its foes. A creature that meets the gaze of the central eye must roll a successful saving throws vs. spell, with a -2 penalty, or be affected as if the victim of a feeblemind spell. If a gauth chooses to bite with its great maw, the sharp fangs inflict 3d4 points of damage. The four tendrils around the mouth can grab and hold victims as if they had Strength of 18, but they can inflict no damage.

A gauth in combat can also employ its six eyestalks. These eyes have the following powers: 1. Cause serious wounds (as spell, 30-foot range). 2. Repulsion (as spell, 10-foot wide path, 40-foot range) 3. Cone of cold (as spell, inflicts 3d4 points of damage and has an area of effect 5 feet wide at the start, 50 feet long, and 20 feet wide at the base; this eye can be used only three times per day) 4. Lightning bolt (as spell, inflicts 4d4 damage with 80' range; this power can be used up to four times per day) 5. Paralyzation (as wand, 40-foot range, single target; only a dispel magic or the beholder's death can free the victim) 6. Dweomer drain (see below)

Dweomer drain permits the gauth to drain charges from magical items. It has a 40-foot range and can be targeted on one individual per round. In addition to preventing one object from functioning for the duration of that round, this power drains one charge from one charged object. Permanent objects, such as magical swords, are rendered powerless for one round by this ability. The dweomer drain does not affect artifacts. The eye has no effect on spells that

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have been memorized (but not yet cast) and it will not break the concentration of a wizard. It does neutralize any spell cast by its target that round, however.

A dispel magic spell cast on any of the gauth's eyestalks prevents its use for 1d4 rounds. The central eye, any fully retracted eyestalks, the body's ability to glow, and the gauth's natural levitation are not subject to injury by such a spell.

If a gauth is slain, its magical energy dissipates. Usually, this is a harmless event, but there is a 2% chance that it is catastrophic, inflicting 4d4 points of damage to all creatures within 10 feet (no saving throw). Gauth are immune to their own powers and to those of other gauth. They have an unusual physiology that enables them to regenerate 1 hit point every two turns.

Saving Throws:

Creature hit points	Saves as
45-49	10th level warrior
50-59	12th level warrior
60-69	14th level warrior
70+	16th level warrior

If the battle goes against the gauth, it will plummet through the hole under the hay pile and retreat into its lair room number #T6.

The statues are normal stone statues carved of fine granite by a master craftsman with morbid tastes. To an interested collector each statue might fetch 5-10 gp, but the weight of each statue and the trouble of transporting them are not worth the effort.

T3, The Tower Second Level.

This room is almost identical in size and layout as the one below it, however in this room the stairs run up the southern wall. A large, moldy and badly stained rug lies in a crumpled heap under the stairs. A fireplace fills the center of the western wall with a ruined chase lounge in front of it. Beside the fireplace on the left is a small wooden nightstand with the twin doors ripped off the face lying upon its side against the wall. Lying on its side in the southwestern corner of the room is a small wooden table with three legs. A few pine needles rest on the table's edge. The wooden roof is badly warped and water-damaged, and has a fierce case of mold and rot. The floor in this room shows signs of water damage and the beginning of rot and mildew. Occasionally a small drop of water falls through the roof.

Closer inspection reveals that the tabletop is badly gouged, punctured in several places, and might have served as a target for some bodies practice. Searching the nightstand reveals that it is empty and worthless. Under the nightstand is a small secret trap door that is locked but not trapped. Inside the small wooden recess in the floor is: a unique small *Bag Of Holding 175 Pounds* that contains 40 gp (ancient Waterdeep mint), 30 brilliant rubies (exquisite fakes that appear to be worth 40 gp each), and two delicate pink crystal vials of *Extra-Healing Potions* (each poisoned with a single *Invisible* throat leech).

Leech, Throat (2): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 10; MV 1, Sw 1; HD 0+1; hp 2x1; THAC0 20; #AT 1; Dmg 1-3; SA choke; SZ T; ML Unsteady (6); XP 35.

T4, The Tower Third Level.

Entering this room, you would assume that it would be very similar to the two previous rooms; with the exception, that most of this room and the rest of the tower has fallen to the ground below. A short flight of stairs ending in space runs briefly along the western wall. Small puddles of water dot this room and the floor makes ominous noises when stepped on. A gaping hole in the western wall is all that remains of the fireplace, and small birds have roosted in some of the remaining stones. A large portion of the north and eastern walls survive. Lying on its side in the northeast corner is a large iron bound chest that is badly scratched and dented but seems sound. A lock made of iron is inset into the chest, and this area has suffered the most abuse, but it seems to no avail.

The chest has a 10th-level *Wizard Lock* spell upon it as well as a rusty padlock effectively welding the chest shut. Opening the chest requires a total of 75 points of damage be dealt to it, or a strong acid or other means allowing access. The DM should reward creative players that gain access to the chest without damaging the contents. Opening the chest reveals 15 gp, 15 sp (ancient Silvermoon mint), three gold trade bars each worth 150 gp and three scrolls in a cracked leather case. The scrolls bear the spells *Knock*, *Wizard Eye*, and *Fireball*. Under the scrolls is a pair of matched throwing daggers and nine vial bombs¹¹ whose command phrase is "From mine, unto thine, may you suffer the ills of my gift" which must be spoken the night before use, which magically fills the activated vial with *Firewater*¹² creating a magical grenade.

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Searching the chest for secret compartments reveals a false bottom. Searching the false bottom for traps reveals a complex poisoned needle trap, of such design that the thief attempting to disarm the trap suffers a –25% chance of success. Failure to disarm the trap triggers the poison needle, which is coated with class D poison¹³. Opening the secret compartment reveals a small silvery cloth bag, and an ivory scroll case sealed with red wax. Inside the bag are four large magical candles. Three of these candles are *Candles Of Defense*¹⁴ and one is a *Candle Of Flame*, which may be mistaken for one of the other three candles.

The scroll case is protected by a 12th-level *Sepia Snake Sigil* spell. Opening the scroll case reveals a single piece of parchment with a short riddle upon it:

“I am the twin faced-god of beginning,

My name starts the new year.

All doors and gates fall under my protection.

Open my door in time of war,

Close my door in time of peace.

Speak my name so that what was hid shall be revealed.”

The answer is Janus¹⁵ and speaking the deity’s name aloud causes a small magical vortex to open depositing a large mirror in the northeast corner of the room.

Suddenly a magical vortex erupts within the room and deposits a large, body-sized mirror mounted to the walls in the northeast corner. A thick, gilded iron frame holds the mirror, which seems to be made of a single pane of glass.

The mirror and its frame are quite shiny and appear as if freshly made. Apparently stored within some extra-dimensional space, the magic within the area prevented that portion of the tower from collapsing. Casting a *Detect Magic* spell upon the mirror reveals that it is quite magical. Tossing anything into the mirror causes it to disappear instantly. The mirror is a one-way *Mirror of Teleportation* that sends one man-sized and smaller object entering the mirror to a fixed location with the Underdark per round. The location is room number one in the Under Halls. The mirror will remain on this dimension for one turn, after which it disappears again until called forth by the command word. The mirror is a relic, is indestructible, and is not able to be removed.

If the characters have not encountered the gauth, and they have discovered the mirror’s properties (which the gauth may have observed), it will immediately attack. Another option is holding the gauth’s attack back until part of the party has passed through the mirror and attacking those remaining. Of course, the gauth will follow the characters into the mirror and the renegade drow will not be thrilled at the appearance of a gauth following the characters.

T5, The Basement of the Tower.

The vertical hole through the floor appears to be the only means of accessing the basement. If there was another way, it has probably been destroyed.

The 10’-diameter vertical shaft descends 30’ through the rock and earth to end in an expertly hallowed-out basement under the tower. A smooth stone landing that is 15’ wide and 20’ long lies at the center of the shaft within a room that is 25’ wide and 30’ long. At the northern end of the room, a large stone arch permits access into the next room. A pair of ruined iron-reinforced doors lie just outside the room, the remains of the hinges are still hanging upon the stone walls. The walls are very smooth and the rooms still air is musty with a thick poignant aroma, like rotting vegetation. Surrounding the landing on all sides is a thick patch of fungi that completely covers the floor and ends at the stone arch. Several of the fungi are nearly five feet tall.

The gauth has carefully tended and cultivated this patch of fungi, even carrying water to it from the forest within its mouth. The gauth dumps the carcasses from its meals and any other handy matter within the fungi to feed it. There are ten shriekers and five violet fungi; the rest of the fungi are normal, if large specimens.

Fungus, Shrieker (10): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 7; MV 1; HD 3; hp 2x10, 11, 16, 17, 6, 20, 18, 23, 5; THAC0 17; #AT 0; Dmg Nil; SD Noise; SZ M; ML Steady (12); XP 120.

Fungus, Violet (5): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 7; MV 1; HD 3; hp 19, 14, 10, 11, 6; THAC0 17; #AT 1-4; Dmg Special; SA Rot flesh in one round unless save vs. poison; SZ M; ML Steady (12); XP 175.

The ruined doors were forced from inside the room with the fungi. There are no obvious tool marks upon the doors to suggest how they might have been forced. Lifting the doors reveals a broken oak crosspiece lying on the stone floor under the doors.

T6, The Living Quarters of the Gauth.

This large, rough-hewn cavern has a roof 15’ high and the room is approximately 48’ wide and 60’ long. The walls are rough with the cracks and crevices left from excavation. The room is dark, musty, and dotted with piles of

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debris. Most of the debris is what you would expect to find in a large storeroom under a keep, barrels of provisions, crates of supplies, and other usual material. Several of these crates and barrels have been ransacked and some of the material is scattered about the room. Towards the back of the room in the southern part, is a large pile of material making what looks like a nest. Along the western wall are piles of hay bales and sacks of molding grain, along with several ruined saddles and other pieces of tack.

The DM should adjust the description of the room to match the events that have happened so far. Should the gauth already be slain, then its lair is running loose within the room, and make sure that you mention the movement. A wounded gauth would retreat here and the final battle could end within this room. In the unlikely event that the gauth is still alive, then its lair will still be frozen which consists of three mule deer, a large black bear, and a winged owlbear. The deer and black bear are too confused to pose a threat to the characters, but the owlbear is quite enraged and will attack.

Winged Owlbear: Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL N; AC 3; MV 12; HD 7+2; hp 44; THAC0 12; #AT 3; Dmg 1-8/1-8/3-12; SA If hit with 18 or better, victim is drawn into hug (2-16/rnd auto hit); SZ L; ML Steady (11-12); XP 420.

Bear, Black: Int. 2-4 Semi-intelligent; AL N; AC 7; MV 12; HD 3+3; hp 19; THAC0 17; #AT 3; Dmg 1-3/1-3/1-6; SA Hug (2d4); SZ M; ML Average (8-10); XP 175.

The deer are AC 7 and each has 8 hp but they are non-combatants. A Ranger character has a slight chance of pacifying the deer, but with the scents of so many predators around, it will be difficult. Speaking to the deer provides no useful information; the deer have no idea of how much time has elapsed.

Searching the room reveals several torch scones along both walls from which 15 usable torches are recovered. Searching the crates reveals several brass hooded lanterns and several gallons of lamp oil. Underneath the false hay pile is the remains of a large dumbwaiter, once used to raise and lower supplies from the storage area. Within the large pile of debris in the center of the room, are two large pieces of art worth 1,198 and 776 gp respectfully to an interested collector. In the wrong market, both objects might fetch one-eighth of their value. Buried in the center of the pile is a large open and unlocked chest of coins. The chest contains 81 pp, 2,099 cp, 41 gp, and four glass vials filled with liquid and a metallic flask with a bronze stopper filled with an orange fluid. The four glass vials are three *Potions of Extra-Healing*, and one *Potion of Superheroism*. The metallic flask contains a *Potion of Rainbow Hues* with enough for seven careful draughts.

The Under Halls

While traveling within the Under Halls, the DM should check twice per day and once per night for random encounters. A DM desiring to expand these halls may wish to create new encounter tables.

Underdark Random Encounters

Roll	Result
1	Troglodyte (11): Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL CE; AC 5; MV 12; HD 2; hp 12, 6, 3x14, 3x11, 2x8, 7; THAC0 19; #AT 3; Dmg 1-2/1-2/2-5 or 2-8 weapon; SZ M; ML Steady (11); XP 120. Troglodyte, Guard (5): Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL CE; AC 5; MV 12; HD 3; hp 15, 12, 11, 18, 7; THAC0 17; #AT 3; Dmg 1-2/1-2/2-5 or 2-8 weapon; SZ M; ML Steady (11); XP 175. Troglodyte, Subchieftain (4): Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL CE; AC 5; MV 12; HD 4; hp 22, 2x14, 23; THAC0 17; #AT 3; Dmg 1-2/1-2/2-5 or 2-8 weapon; SZ M; ML Steady (11); XP 270.
2	Lizard, Subterranean (5): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 5; MV 12; HD 6; hp 22, 29, 31, 17, 32; THAC0 15; #AT 1; Dmg 2-12; SA If hits with a 20, take double dmg (2-24) and 2-12 each rnd (no attack roll); SZ H; ML Average (8-10); XP 650.
3	Spider, Huge (3): Int. 1 Animal intelligence; AL N; AC 6; MV 18; HD 2+2; hp 14, 10, 16; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-6; SA Poison, leap; SZ M; ML Average (8); XP 270.
4	Tren (10): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL CE; AC 4; MV 12, Sw 9; HD 3+3; hp 18, 2x13, 2x14, 9, 10, 12, 23, 11; THAC0 17; #AT 3 or 1; Dmg 1d3/1d3/1d6+1 or by weapon; SA See Below; SD See Below; SZ M; ML Elite (13-14); XP 175.
5	Ghoul, Ghast (4): Int. 11-12 Very intelligent; AL CE; AC 4; MV 15; HD 4; hp 18, 17, 14, 24; THAC0 17; #AT 3; Dmg 1-4/1-4/1-8; SA paralyzation (5-10 rnds), save vs. stench (-2) or retching & nausea; SD immune to sleep & charm, take double dmg from cold iron weapons; SZ M; ML Elite (13-14); XP 650. Ghoul (10): Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL CE; AC 6; MV 9; HD 2; hp 2x13, 14, 8, 2x10, 2x11, 15, 4; THAC0 19; #AT 3; Dmg 1-3/1-3/1-6; SA Paralyzation (3-8 turns); SD immune to sleep & charm; SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 175.